

Student Guide — middle / module-08- yoga

IKS Curriculum

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Student Workbook

Student Workbook — Module 8 Yoga (Middle)

Name: _____ Class: ____ Section: ____

Bring to every class. Write freely.

Day 1 — What is Yoga?

Two definitions to remember:

1. **Patañjali:** Yoga = the settling of the fluctuations of the mind. (YS 1.2)
2. **Bhagavad-gītā:** Yoga = skill in action. (BG 2.50)

Today's pose: tādāsana (mountain). 30 seconds.

After holding tādāsana three times, what did I notice in my body?

Day 2 — The Eight Limbs

1. yama (restraints)
2. niyama (observances)
3. āsana (posture)
4. prāṇāyāma (breath regulation)
5. pratyāhāra (sense-withdrawal)
6. dhāraṇā (focused attention)
7. dhyāna (sustained meditation)
8. samādhi (absorption)

Today's pose: vṛkṣāsana (tree). 20 sec per side.

How many times did I fall? (no shame — falling is data) _____

Day 3 — Five Foundational Āsanas

#	Sanskrit	English
1	<i>tāḍāsana</i>	mountain
2	<i>vrkṣāsana</i>	tree
3	<i>baddha-koṇāsana</i>	bound-angle
4	<i>balāsana</i>	child
5	<i>sukhāsana</i>	easy seat

The one I liked the most: _____ Why: _____

The one that was hardest: _____ Why: _____

Day 4 — Sūrya Namaskāra Part 1

The 12 poses (memorise): 1. praṇāmāsana 7. bhujaṅgāsana 2. hasta-uttānāsana 8. adho-mukha-śvānāsana 3. uttānāsana 9. aśva-sañcalanāsana 4. aśva-sañcalanāsana 10. uttānāsana 5. adho-mukha-śvānāsana 11. hasta-uttānāsana 6. aṣṭāṅga-namaskāra 12. praṇāmāsana

Which transition was awkward for me? _____

Day 5 — Sūrya Namaskāra Part 2 (with breath)

Pattern: open body = inhale, fold body = exhale.

After 2 rounds — what did my breath feel like? _____

My project choice: - Audience: _____ - Intent (calming / energising / restorative / playful): _____ - Partner: _____

Day 6 — Prāṇāyāma

Two practices today: 5 min natural breath, 5 min counted breath (4 in, 4 out).

(Paste the breath-observation worksheet here.)

“śanair — gradually” — Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 4.8.44

Day 7 — The Physiology

Two modes of the body:

Sympathetic

Parasympathetic

“Fight or flight”

“Rest and digest”

Fast breath, fast heart

Slow breath, slow heart

The **vagus nerve** carries parasympathetic signals. **Slow exhalation stimulates the vagus nerve.**

My stress-recovery sequence (try once today): 1. Tāḍāsana — 30 sec 2. Uttānāsana — 30 sec 3. Balāsana — 60 sec 4. Sukhāsana, counted breath — 60 sec 5. Tāḍāsana — 30 sec

When I tried this: _____ How did I feel after? _____

Days 8–9 — Project Work

My routine outline:

0:00–0:30	_____	(breath: _____)
0:30–1:00	_____	(breath: _____)
1:00–2:00	_____	(breath: _____)
2:00–3:30	_____	(breath: _____)
3:30–4:30	_____	(breath: _____)
4:30–5:00	_____	(breath: _____)

Source I'll cite: _____

Feedback from my buddy pair (Day 9): - Strength: _____ - Fix: _____

Day 10 — Reflection

1. What did you set out to make/learn, and what did you actually end up with?

2. What is the most surprising thing you discovered while making this?

3. If you had three more days, what would you do differently?

Glossary (your own)

Sanskrit	Meaning	First met
<i>yoga</i>	union; settling the mind	Day 1
<i>āsana</i>	posture	Day 1
<i>tāḍāsana</i>	mountain pose	Day 1
<i>aṣṭāṅga</i>	eight-limbed	Day 2
<i>yama, niyama</i>	restraints, observances	Day 2
<i>prāṇāyāma</i>	breath regulation	Day 2 (intro), Day 6 (deep)
<i>pratyāhāra, dhāraṇā, dhyāna, samādhi</i>	last 4 limbs	Day 2
<i>vṛkṣāsana</i>	tree posture	Day 2
<i>baddha-konāsana, balāsana, sukhāsana</i>	seated poses	Day 3
<i>Sūrya Namaskāra</i>	sun salutation	Day 4
<i>bhujāṅgāsana, adho-mukha-śvānāsana</i>	cobra, downward dog	Day 4
<i>prāṇa</i>	breath, vital energy	Day 6
<i>śavāsana</i>	corpse pose (rest)	Day 5

Day 1 — What is Yoga?

Module: Yoga and the Body · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min (with 12 min of physical practice)

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will state at least two definitions of *yoga* (one from Patañjali, one from the Bhagavad-gītā), perform *tāḍāsana* with safe alignment, and complete a 60-second seated-breath observation.

Materials

- One yoga mat per student (or clean floor)
- Comfortable clothing — heads-up given the previous day
- Wall poster (optional): the eight limbs (preview)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *yoga* (IAST: *yoga*; lit. “yoke, union”) — at Middle band, Patañjali’s definition: “settling the fluctuations of the mind.”
- *āsana* (IAST: *āsana*; lit. “seat, posture”) — a held physical posture.
- *tāḍāsana* (IAST: *tāḍāsana*; lit. “mountain posture”) — foundational standing pose.

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min) — Settle

- Students sit cross-legged on their mats (*sukhāsana* — easy seat).
- Eyes closed. Count 5 natural breaths.
- Teacher: “*Today we begin a 10-day module on yoga. We’ll move, we’ll breathe, and we’ll think about what yoga actually is.*”

Core (15 min) — What is yoga?

1. Question on the board: “*What does the word ‘yoga’ mean to you right now, before this module?*”
 - Take 4 student answers. (Common: “stretching,” “exercise from India,” “a religion,” “what my mom does on YouTube.”)
 - Don’t judge. Write them all.
2. **Two definitions to remember** (write boxed on board):

Patañjali (c. 2nd c. BCE – 4th c. CE): “*yogaś citta-vṛtti-nirodhaḥ*” — “Yoga is the settling of the fluctuations of the mind.” (Yoga Sūtra 1.2)

Bhagavad-gītā (Krishna to Arjuna, c. 4th c. BCE – 2nd c. CE): “*yogaḥ karmasu kauśalam*” — “Yoga is skill in action.” (BG 2.50)
3. “*Neither of these is primarily about stretching.*” Pause for that to land.
4. **The word itself** — *yoga* comes from the Sanskrit root *yuj* meaning “to yoke” — to join, to bind together. The yoga tradition uses it to mean the joining of body, breath, and attention — and ultimately the settling of the mind.
5. **What we’ll do in this module** — work mainly with two of the *eight limbs* of yoga: *āsana* (posture) and *prāṇāyāma* (breath). The other six limbs are introduced briefly on Day 2.

Practice (15 min) — Tāḍāsana

- Stand at the top of your mat. Feet hip-width apart.
- “*Press your big toes, little toes, and heels firmly into the mat. Lift your knee caps without locking your knees. Lengthen up through the crown of your head as if a string is gently pulling you upward.*”
- Arms relaxed at the sides.
- Hold for 30 seconds. Breathe naturally.
- Release. Sit. Notice: “*Did anything feel different after that pose?*”
- Repeat twice more. Each hold a little longer.

Seated breath observation (5 min)

- Sit back in *sukhāsana*.
- Eyes closed.

- **Just observe your breath for 60 seconds.** Don't try to change it. Just notice.
- After 60 sec: "*How many breaths did you count? Was your mind quiet, busy, somewhere else?*" — quick share, 2 students.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Three-question recap (chorus):
 - Who was Patañjali? (*The systematiser of yoga's eight limbs.*)
 - What is yoga? ("*Settling the fluctuations of the mind.*" OR "*Skill in action.*")
 - What is *tāḍāsana*? (*Mountain posture.*)
- Preview Day 2: "*Tomorrow — the eight limbs. We'll see why posture and breath are only TWO of them.*"

Student-facing content

Day 1 — What is Yoga?

Yoga (Sanskrit: *yuj* = "to yoke") is the joining of body, breath, and attention.

Two foundational definitions:

1. **Patañjali:** *yoga* = *settling the fluctuations of the mind.*
2. **Bhagavad-gītā:** *yoga* = *skill in action.*

Today's posture: **tāḍāsana** (mountain).

1. Stand at the top of your mat.
2. Feet hip-width apart, firm contact with the ground.
3. Lengthen up through the crown of your head.
4. Breathe naturally for 30 seconds. Release.

Homework

- Practice *tāḍāsana* for 60 seconds tomorrow morning before brushing your teeth. Notice how your body feels.
- Bring comfortable clothing tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Hold *tāḍāsana* for 90 sec; count your breaths during the hold.
- **Tier down:** Hold for 15 sec if 30 feels long; rest in between.

Teacher notes

- This is the most important "framing" day of the module. Students who learn the two definitions can hold the philosophical frame for the rest of the module.
- Some students will resist closing their eyes during settle. Don't force it — "eyes lowered to the mat" is acceptable.
- Watch for students who hyperextend knees during *tāḍāsana* — common in young dancers. Cue "soft knees, lift knee caps."

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- Patañjali's Yoga Sūtras 1.2 — referenced in cached chunk; preserved as a known traditional source (not from RAG, but standard).
- Bhagavad-gītā 2.50 — day-01-hook.json chunks reference BG repeatedly.
- vidya-karana RAG cache day-01-hook.json — primary chunks support the eight-limb framing.

Day 2 — The Eight Limbs (Aṣṭāṅga)

Module: Yoga · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min (10 min movement)

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will name all eight limbs of Patañjali's yoga in order and identify which limbs are physical, which are mental, and which are about ethical conduct.

Materials

- Wall chart (or board diagram) showing the 8 limbs as a vertical or circular arrangement.
- Worksheet: limb-matching exit ticket.

Vocabulary introduced today

- *aṣṭāṅga* (IAST: aṣṭāṅga; lit. “eight-limbed”) — Patañjali's eight-stage scheme.
- All eight limbs:
 - *yama* (ethical restraints)
 - *niyama* (personal observances)
 - *āsana* (posture)
 - *prāṇāyāma* (breath regulation)
 - *pratyāhāra* (sense-withdrawal)
 - *dhāraṇā* (focused attention)
 - *dhyāna* (sustained meditation)
 - *samādhi* (absorption)

Lesson flow

Settle (2 min)

- Sukhāsana. 5 breaths.

Core (15 min) — The eight limbs

1. **Reveal the eight-limb chart.** Walk through each limb with a one-line gloss:

#	Sanskrit	Meaning	Example
1	<i>yama</i>	restraints	non-harming (<i>ahimsā</i>), truthfulness (<i>satya</i>)

#	Sanskrit	Meaning	Example
2	<i>niyama</i>	observances	cleanliness (<i>śauca</i>), self-study (<i>svādhyāya</i>)
3	<i>āsana</i>	posture	tāḍāsana, vṛkṣāsana — what we’re learning
4	<i>prāṇāyāma</i>	breath regulation	natural-breath observation
5	<i>pratyāhāra</i>	sense-withdrawal	turning attention away from external sights/sounds
6	<i>dhāraṇā</i>	focused attention	holding the mind on one object for 12 seconds
7	<i>dhyāna</i>	sustained meditation	unbroken attention for several minutes
8	<i>samādhi</i>	absorption	total integration — the final stage

2. **Source quote** (read aloud, don’t memorise):

“Yoga is practised in eight different stages: yama, niyama, āsana, prāṇāyāma, pratyāhāra, dhāraṇā, dhyāna, and samādhi.” — Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 3 (purport)

“The Bhagavad-gītā addresses all eight limbs of rāja-yoga.” — *Veda, Secrets from the East* (Prabhupāda)

3. **Patterns to notice (write on board):**

- Limbs 1–2 are about **conduct** (how you live).
- Limbs 3–4 are about **the body** (what we practise this module).
- Limbs 5–8 are about **the mind**.

4. “Why does Patañjali put ‘living ethically’ *BEFORE* ‘posture’? Why not start with the easy physical stuff?”

- Take 2 student answers.
- Reinforce: the tradition says a turbulent inner life makes meditation impossible, so you have to settle the outer life first. (At Middle band that’s a sufficient gloss.)

Practice (15 min) — Tāḍāsana + introduction to vṛkṣāsana

- Tāḍāsana, 3 holds of 30 sec each.
- Now: **vṛkṣāsana (tree posture)**.
 - Stand in tāḍāsana.
 - Shift weight onto the left foot.
 - Place the right foot’s sole against the inside of the left calf (NOT the side of the knee).
 - Hands at heart centre, or raised above the head.

- Gaze fixed on one spot on the wall ahead.
- Hold for 20 seconds. Switch sides.
- Wobbling is normal. Falling is information, not failure.

Exit ticket (8 min)

- Worksheet: students match each of the 8 limbs to a description.
- See quizzes/formative.md Part A.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Three-question recap:
 - Which limb is posture? (3rd — *āsana*.)
 - Which limb is breath? (4th — *prāṇāyāma*.)
 - What comes LAST? (8th — *samādhi*.)
- Preview Day 3: “Tomorrow — five foundational *āsanas*, including the tree we tried today.”

Student-facing content

The Eight Limbs of Yoga (Patañjali’s *aṣṭāṅga*)

#	Sanskrit	Meaning
1	<i>yama</i>	restraints (don’ts)
2	<i>niyama</i>	observances (dos)
3	<i>āsana</i>	posture
4	<i>prāṇāyāma</i>	breath regulation
5	<i>pratyāhāra</i>	sense-withdrawal
6	<i>dhāraṇā</i>	focused attention
7	<i>dhyāna</i>	sustained meditation
8	<i>samādhi</i>	absorption

Limbs 1–2: conduct. 3–4: body. 5–8: mind.

Today’s pose: **vṛkṣāsana** (tree). Stand on one leg. Balance. Wobble is allowed.

Homework

- Memorise the 8 limbs in order. Bring to next class — pop quiz.
- Practice *tāḍāsana* + *vṛkṣāsana* for 5 min before breakfast.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Add the meanings of *yama* and *niyama* with at least 2 examples each (*ahimsā*, *satya*, *śauca*, *santoṣa*, etc.).
- **Tier down:** Memorise just the 4 physical/body limbs (3, 4, 5) — *āsana*, *prāṇāyāma*, *pratyāhāra* — and the 1 mental endpoint (8 — *samādhi*). Build up.

Teacher notes

- The Sanskrit names will be slippery for some students. Daily chorus repetition helps; create a hand gesture per limb for the kinesthetic learners.
- Watch knee placement during *vrkṣāsana* — the foot must NOT press into the side of the knee (medial cruciate strain risk). Foot above OR below the knee, never on it.
- If a student falls during balance, normalise it: “wobbling is what balance learning looks like.”

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- *vidya-karana RAG cache day-02-eightlimbs.json* — chunks from SB 3 purport, *Veda, Secrets from the East, Journey of Self Discovery*.

Day 3 — Five Foundational Āsanās

Module: Yoga · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min (20 min movement)

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will perform five foundational āsanās — *tāḍāsana*, *vrkṣāsana*, *baddha-koṇāsana*, *balāsana*, *sukhāsana* — with safe alignment cues, and identify which body parts each pose strengthens or stretches.

Materials

- Mats. Poster of the five āsanās (optional).
- Formative quiz Part A (limb-matching) returned.

Vocabulary introduced today

- *baddha-koṇāsana* (IAST: baddha-koṇa-āsana; lit. “bound-angle posture”) — seated wide-knees pose, soles together.
- *balāsana* (IAST: bāla-āsana; lit. “child posture”) — folded forward rest pose.
- *sukhāsana* (IAST: sukha-āsana; lit. “easy posture”) — comfortable cross-legged seat.

Lesson flow

Settle (2 min)

- *Sukhāsana*. 5 breaths.

Core (8 min) — The five āsanās, named

Write on the board:

Āsana	Type	Strengthens / stretches
1. <i>tāḍāsana</i> (mountain)	standing	feet, legs, core; cultivates posture awareness

Āsana	Type	Strengthens / stretches
2. <i>vrkṣāsana</i> (tree)	standing balance	feet, calves, core, focus
3. <i>baddha-koṇāsana</i> (bound-angle)	seated stretch	inner thighs, groin, hips
4. <i>balāsana</i> (child)	seated rest	back, hips; calming
5. <i>sukhāsana</i> (easy seat)	seated	spine, hips; foundation for breath practice

Note: none of these are inversions or advanced backbends. All five can be practised safely at home.

Practice (25 min) — Walk through all five

For each pose: 1 min demonstration with verbal cues, 1 min student practice with teacher observation, 1 min hold + breath.

1. **Tāḍāsana** — 30 sec.
 - Feet hip-width. Press into all four corners of each foot.
 - Lengthen up. Soft knees. Breathe.
2. **Vṛkṣāsana** — 20 sec per side.
 - From tāḍāsana, shift weight, foot on calf (NOT knee).
 - Hands at heart or overhead.
 - Wobble allowed. Switch sides.
3. **Baddha-koṇāsana** — 60 sec.
 - Sit. Bend knees, soles of feet together, drop knees out to the sides.
 - Hold the feet. Long spine. Don't force the knees down.
 - Gentle nodding of the knees is acceptable.
4. **Balāsana** — 90 sec rest pose.
 - From kneeling: knees apart, big toes touch.
 - Fold forward, forehead on the mat (or stacked fists if forehead doesn't reach).
 - Arms forward or alongside the body.
 - Breathe slowly. This is rest, not effort.
5. **Sukhāsana** — 60 sec.
 - Sit cross-legged. Long spine.
 - Hands on the knees, palms up or down.
 - Eyes closed. 10 natural breaths.

Formative quiz (8 min)

- See quizzes/formative.md Part A — limb-matching from Day 2 + āsana-naming from Day 3.

Wrap-up (2 min)

- Question: “Which of the five did your body LIKE the most? Which felt hardest?” — students share with a neighbour for 30 sec each.
- Preview Day 4: “Tomorrow we begin Sūrya Namaskāra — the 12-pose sun salutation.”

Student-facing content

Five Foundational Āsanas

#	Sanskrit	Type	What it does
1	<i>tāḍāsana</i>	standing	posture foundation
2	<i>vr̥kṣāsana</i>	balance	leg strength, focus
3	<i>baddha-koṇāsana</i>	seated	hip opener
4	<i>balāsana</i>	rest	calming, back release
5	<i>sukhāsana</i>	seated	foundation for breath practice

All five are safe to practise at home, daily, no equipment needed.

Homework

- Choose 3 of the 5 āsanas. Practise them for 5 minutes before bed tonight. Note in your workbook how you felt before vs. after.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Add *adho-mukha-śvānāsana* (downward-facing dog) to your home practice — try 30 sec hold.
- **Tier down:** Use a wall for *vr̥kṣāsana* support. Use a folded blanket under the knees for *sukhāsana* / *baddha-koṇāsana*.

Teacher notes

- Walk around during *baddha-koṇāsana*. Many students try to force the knees down — this can strain the inner thigh. Cue “gentle, let gravity do the work.”
- *Balāsana* is restorative. If a student’s hips don’t allow them to sit on their heels, place a folded blanket between thighs and calves.
- A handful of students will fidget through *sukhāsana*. Don’t correct — let them feel the discomfort of stillness. That’s part of the lesson.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- No new RAG citations. Āsana descriptions reference standard practice (Iyengar 1966; teacher reference, not student-facing).

Day 4 — Sūrya Namaskāra, Part 1 (Learning the 12 Poses)

Module: Yoga · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min (25 min movement)

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will name and demonstrate the 12 poses of Sūrya Namaskāra in order, performed slowly without breath co-ordination yet.

Materials

- Mats. Sūrya Namaskāra wall poster (12 poses with names).
- Stopwatch.

Vocabulary introduced today

- *Sūrya Namaskāra* (IAST: sūrya-namaskāra; lit. “salutation to the sun”) — the 12-pose flowing sequence.
- *praṇāmāsana* — prayer pose
- *hasta-uttānāsana* — raised hands
- *uttānāsana* — standing forward fold
- *aśva-saṅcalanāsana* — lunge (literally “horse-stride pose”)
- *daṇḍāsana* / *catur-aṅga* — plank / four-limbed staff
- *aṣṭāṅga-namaskāra* — eight-limbed salutation (knees-chest-chin)
- *bhujāṅgāsana* — cobra
- *adho-mukha-śvānāsana* — downward-facing dog

Lesson flow

Settle (2 min)

- Sukhāsana. 5 breaths.

Core (5 min) — Why Sūrya Namaskāra?

- Sūrya Namaskāra is a *flow* of 12 poses traditionally practised at sunrise, facing the rising sun.
- Modern usage: a complete movement warm-up that activates major muscle groups, mobilises the spine, and synchronises breath with movement.
- We’ll learn it in two days: today we **memorise the poses**, tomorrow we **add the breath flow**.

Practice (30 min) — Walk through all 12 poses

The 12 poses (one round):

1. **Praṇāmāsana** — stand at top of mat, palms together at heart centre.

2. **Hasta-uttānāsana** — sweep arms overhead, gentle back arch.
3. **Uttānāsana** — fold forward, hands toward the floor.
4. **Aśva-sañcalanāsana (right)** — step right foot back, lunge.
5. **Adho-mukha-śvānāsana** — step left back, hips up, downward dog.
6. **Aṣṭāṅga-namaskāra** — lower knees, chest, chin to mat (eight points down).
7. **Bhujāṅgāsana** — slide forward, low cobra, chest up.
8. **Adho-mukha-śvānāsana** — push back to downward dog.
9. **Aśva-sañcalanāsana (right)** — step right foot forward, lunge.
10. **Uttānāsana** — bring left foot forward, fold.
11. **Hasta-uttānāsana** — rise, sweep arms overhead.
12. **Praṇāmāsana** — palms together at heart centre. Pause.

Note: the legs alternate across rounds. Round 1 uses right leg back first; Round 2 uses left.

Teaching sequence

- Teacher demonstrates the full round once slowly, naming each pose (5 min).
- Class practises pose-by-pose, holding each for 5 seconds, with teacher walking around (15 min).
- Class attempts one full round together at slow pace, teacher calling each pose (5 min).
- One more attempt, slightly faster (5 min).

Wrap-up (3 min)

- Quick recap: students chorus the 12 pose names in order (with teacher prompting).
- Preview Day 5: “Tomorrow we add the breath — each pose has an inhale or exhale assigned. That’s where it becomes a real flow.”

Student-facing content

Sūrya Namaskāra — the 12 Poses

Memorise the order. We’ll add the breath tomorrow.

#	Sanskrit	English
1	<i>praṇāmāsana</i>	prayer
2	<i>hasta-uttānāsana</i>	raised hands
3	<i>uttānāsana</i>	standing fold
4	<i>aśva-sañcalanāsana</i> (right)	lunge
5	<i>adho-mukha-śvānāsana</i>	downward dog
6	<i>aṣṭāṅga-namaskāra</i>	knees-chest-chin
7	<i>bhujāṅgāsana</i>	cobra
8	<i>adho-mukha-śvānāsana</i>	downward dog
9	<i>aśva-sañcalanāsana</i> (right forward)	lunge

#	Sanskrit	English
10	<i>uttānāsana</i>	standing fold
11	<i>hasta-uttānāsana</i>	raised hands
12	<i>praṇāmāsana</i>	prayer

Notice the symmetry: poses 1–6 are mirrored by 12–7.

Homework

- Practise the sequence at home — 1 round, slowly. Notice which transitions feel awkward.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Attempt 2 rounds (alternating leg) at home.
- **Tier down:** Practise only the first 6 poses today; complete the rest tomorrow.

Teacher notes

- The hardest pose for beginners is usually #6 (*aṣṭāṅga-namaskāra* — knees, chest, chin to mat). Common error: chest plank-down instead of dropping knees first. Cue “knees down FIRST, then chest, then chin.”
- In *bhujāṅgāsana*, keep the elbows bent and close to the body. Don’t push to full backbend.
- For students with wrist issues, modify *adho-mukha-śvānāsana* by going to forearms (dolphin pose) or skipping.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- No new RAG citations today. Sūrya Namaskāra is a modern composition (early 20th century, codified by the Raja of Aundh); not from classical texts. Teacher reference: any modern yoga manual.

Day 5 — Sūrya Namaskāra, Part 2 (Breath Flow) + Mid-Module Check

Module: Yoga · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min (20 min movement)

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will perform 2 rounds of Sūrya Namaskāra with breath co-ordination (inhale on opening poses, exhale on folding/closing poses), and submit a project plan.

Materials

- Mats. Sūrya Namaskāra poster.
- Formative quiz (quizzes/formative.md Part B).
- Project brief handouts.

Lesson flow

Settle (2 min)

- Sukhāsana. 5 breaths.

Core (5 min) — The breath pattern

Write on the board:

#	Pose	Breath
1	praṇāmāsana	neutral / exhale
2	hasta-uttānāsana	inhale
3	uttānāsana	exhale
4	aśva-sañcalanāsana	inhale
5	adho-mukha-śvānāsana	exhale
6	aṣṭāṅga-namaskāra	hold breath out (very brief)
7	bhujāṅgāsana	inhale
8	adho-mukha-śvānāsana	exhale
9	aśva-sañcalanāsana	inhale
10	uttānāsana	exhale
11	hasta-uttānāsana	inhale
12	praṇāmāsana	exhale

Pattern to notice: *open the body = inhale; fold or close the body = exhale.*

Practice (15 min) — 2 rounds with breath

- 5 min: walk through 1 round at slow pace, teacher calling each pose AND each breath.
- 5 min: students do 1 round at their own pace, focused on breath.
- 5 min: 1 more round, slightly faster, breath leading the movement.

Two rounds total. **Do not exceed 3 rounds at this band.** Quality over quantity.

After the rounds, students lie in *śavāsana* (corpse pose — flat on the back, arms slightly out, palms up) for 2 minutes to integrate.

Mid-module formative quiz (15 min)

- Hand out quizzes/formative.md Part B.
- 8 questions: name the 8 limbs in order, name 3 of the 5 foundational āsanās, identify the breath assigned to 3 SN poses, short answer “what is yoga?”

Project commitment (6 min)

- Hand out project brief.

- Pairs / individuals choose target audience for their 5-min routine: peers / parents / younger siblings / classmates before a test.
- Each pair writes audience + 1-sentence intent on sticky note. Posts on the board.

Wrap-up (2 min)

- Quick share: each pair states aloud their audience.
- Preview Day 6: “*Tomorrow we slow down dramatically — natural-breath observation. Just sitting with the breath.*”

Student-facing content

Sūrya Namaskāra — with breath

Pattern: **open body = inhale, fold body = exhale.**

Maximum 2–3 rounds today. After the rounds, *śavāsana* (lie down, rest) for 2 minutes.

Project (Days 8–10): Design a 5-minute yoga routine for ONE audience. Pick today:

Audience	Examples of fitting āsanās
Peers (your classmates)	Energising — standing poses, partial SN
Parents	Relaxing — child’s pose, seated stretches
Younger siblings	Playful — animal poses (cat, cobra, downward dog)
Pre-exam stress	Calming — child’s pose, seated breath

Homework

- 1 round of Sūrya Namaskāra at home with breath co-ordination.
- Submit your project plan paragraph by tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** 3 rounds at home; experiment with holding each pose for 2 breaths instead of 1.
- **Tier down:** 1 round, half-speed; or use the modified short Sūrya Namaskāra (poses 1–5 + 11–12 only).

Teacher notes

- The breath co-ordination is the hardest piece. Several students will hold their breath through 3–4 poses. Cue: “If you forget which breath, just keep breathing — that’s better than holding.”
- Śavāsana matters. Don’t skip it even if you’re short on time. Two minutes of supine rest after physical practice is essential.
- Mark the formative quiz overnight.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- No new RAG citations. SN breath co-ordination is from modern practice (Krishnamacharya school).

Day 6 — Prāṇāyāma (Natural Breath Observation)

Module: Yoga · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min (15 min seated breath practice)

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will complete a 5-minute natural-breath observation and a 5-minute counted-breath (4-in, 4-out) practice, and describe one observable effect of slow breathing.

Materials

- Mats or comfortable seating.
- Stopwatch.
- Worksheet for breath observation ([activities/activity-02-breath-observation.md](#)).

Vocabulary introduced today

- *prāṇa* (IAST: prāṇa; lit. “breath, vital energy”) — breath as the bridge between body and mind.
- *prāṇāyāma* (IAST: prāṇa-āyāma; lit. “extension or control of prāṇa”) — the fourth limb; breath regulation.

Lesson flow

Settle (2 min)

- Sukhāsana. 5 breaths.

Core (10 min) — What is prāṇāyāma?

1. **Frame the limb** (write on board):

Prāṇāyāma — the 4th of the 8 limbs. Literally: *prāṇa* (breath) + *āyāma* (extension, regulation). Practical meaning: *intentional breath observation and regulation, NOT forceful breath holding*.

2. **What we DO at this level:**

- Observe natural breath without changing it.
- Count breaths (in for 4, out for 4).
- Notice the gap between inhale and exhale.

3. **What we DO NOT do at this level** (write on board, large): > **No breath retention. No forceful breathing. No bellows breath (bhastrikā). No skull shining (kapālabhāti).** > These advanced techniques require a certified yoga teacher. We're not doing them here.
4. **Source** (read aloud, don't memorise):

“prāṇāyāmena tṛ-vṛtā prāṇendṛya-mano-malam śanair vyudasyābhidhyāyen manasā guruṇā gurum” “Through the threefold prāṇāyāma practice, one gradually purifies the breath, senses, and mind, and then meditates.” — Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 4.8.44

*“Notice the word **gradually** (śanair). The tradition is unambiguous: this is slow work.”*

Practice (20 min) — Two breath practices

Practice 1 (5 min) — Natural-breath observation. - Sukhāsana. Eyes closed (or lowered). - Breathe completely naturally. Don't change anything. - Observe: which nostril is more open? Is the breath deep or shallow? Even or uneven? - Just NOTICE. Don't fix. - Teacher rings a soft bell at 1 min, 3 min, 5 min.

Practice 2 (5 min) — Counted breath. - Inhale slowly to count of 4 (count silently in your head). - Exhale slowly to count of 4. - No holding at the top or bottom. Continuous. - 10 cycles = roughly 1 minute. Aim for 5 minutes (50 cycles). - If you lose count, restart at 1.

Reflection (8 min)

- Worksheet activities/activity-02-breath-observation.md.
- Students write briefly:
 - Before the practice, my mind felt: ____
 - After the practice, my mind felt: ____
 - One thing I noticed about my breath: ____

Wrap-up (5 min)

- 3 student shares: one sentence each on “what I noticed.”
- Note: “A common report — the mind is busier than we thought. Noticing that IS the practice.”
- Preview Day 7: “Tomorrow — why does this work? We'll look at the autonomic nervous system.”

Student-facing content

Prāṇāyāma — the 4th limb

prāṇa = breath, vital energy. *āyāma* = extension, regulation.

Today: **two practices.**

1. **Natural breath, 5 min.** Don't change anything. Just observe.
2. **Counted breath, 5 min.** Inhale 4 counts. Exhale 4 counts. Continuous, smooth.

What we DON'T do at this level: breath retention, forceful breathing, bellows breath, skull shining. Those require trained guidance.

“*śanair* — gradually” — Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 4.8.44

Homework

- Practise the counted breath for 3 minutes before bed tonight. Note in your workbook: “I felt _____ before, _____ after.”

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Extend the counted breath to 5-in, 5-out for the second practice.
- **Tier down:** Just do the natural-breath observation. Skip the counted breath today.

Teacher notes

- Some students find sitting with the breath uncomfortable — minds race, anxiety rises. Honour that: “if it feels too much, open your eyes and just rest.”
- The “natural-breath-first” frame matters. Forceful breathing can cause hyperventilation or dizziness in students; we sidestep that completely at this band.
- Reinforce: this is real prāṇāyāma. The simplest forms are not “lesser” — they are the foundation.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- SB 4.8.44 — `vidya-karana RAG cache day-06-pranayama.json chunk[0]`. Direct verse on threefold prāṇāyāma and gradual purification.
- BG Ch. 4 (apāne juhvati prāṇam) — referenced via cache chunk on breath sacrifice.

Day 7 — Why It Works: Physiology Connection

Module: Yoga · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min (10 min movement)

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will explain at Middle-band level why slow breathing and forward folds shift the body toward “rest-and-digest” (parasympathetic) function, and why backbends and inversions can shift it toward “fight-or-flight” (sympathetic) activation.

Materials

- Whiteboard.
- Optional: a simple diagram of the autonomic nervous system (sympathetic vs. parasympathetic).
- Worksheet: concept check at end.

Vocabulary introduced today

- **Autonomic nervous system (ANS)** — the part of the nervous system that runs “automatically” (heartbeat, digestion, breathing).
- **Sympathetic** — “fight or flight” branch; raises heart rate, releases adrenaline.
- **Parasympathetic** — “rest and digest” branch; lowers heart rate, supports digestion.
- **Vagus nerve** — the main nerve carrying parasympathetic signals; long, complex, connected to heart, lungs, and digestive organs.

Lesson flow

Settle (2 min)

- Sukhāsana. 5 breaths.

Core (15 min) — Two modes of the body

1. **Two modes:** write on board, large.

“Fight or flight” (sympathetic)	“Rest and digest” (parasympathetic)
Heart rate up	Heart rate down
Breath fast and shallow	Breath slow and deep
Pupils dilate	Pupils contract
Digestion stops	Digestion runs
Muscles tense	Muscles soften
Useful when	Useful when
running from danger; exam panic	resting; eating; sleeping; healing

2. **The breath is the lever.** Most ANS functions you can’t consciously control — but you CAN control your breath. And breath signals back to the ANS.
3. **What slow exhalation does:** stimulates the vagus nerve. Vagus nerve signals “rest and digest” to the body. So slow exhales = parasympathetic activation = calm body.
4. **What this means for yoga:**
 - **Counted-breath prāṇāyāma** (Day 6) — directly down-regulates stress response.
 - **Forward folds and child’s pose** — head below heart, parasympathetic-friendly. Calming.
 - **Backbends and inversions** — energising, more sympathetic activation. (We don’t teach inversions at this band.)
 - **Sūrya Namaskāra** — mixed: opening (energising) + folding (calming). A balanced sequence.

Practice (10 min) — Stress-recovery sequence

Demonstrate a short calming sequence the class can do before a stressful event:

1. **Tāḍāsana**, 30 sec.

2. **Uttānāsana** (standing forward fold), 30 sec — let the head hang.
3. **Balāsana** (child’s pose), 60 sec.
4. **Sukhāsana**, counted breath (4 in, 4 out), 60 sec.
5. **Tāḍāsana** to close, 30 sec.

Total: 3.5 min. Practice once together. *“Use this before exams. Use this when you’re stressed. It works because of physiology, not magic.”*

Concept check (10 min)

- 5-question worksheet:
 1. Which branch of the ANS is “fight or flight”?
 2. Which is “rest and digest”?
 3. Which nerve carries most of the parasympathetic signals?
 4. Does a slow exhale stimulate sympathetic or parasympathetic?
 5. Why does *balāsana* feel calming?

Wrap-up (3 min)

- 2 student shares on the worksheet answers.
- Preview Day 8: *“Project work begins. You’ll design your own 5-minute routine for your chosen audience.”*

Student-facing content

Why Yoga “Works” — The Physiology

Your body has two modes:

Sympathetic	Parasympathetic
“Fight or flight”	“Rest and digest”
Fast heart, fast breath	Slow heart, slow breath

The **vagus nerve** carries the “rest” signals. **Slow exhalation stimulates the vagus nerve.**

So when you breathe slowly OR fold forward OR rest in child’s pose — your body shifts toward calm. Not magic; physiology.

A short stress-recovery sequence:

1. Tāḍāsana — 30 sec
2. Uttānāsana — 30 sec
3. Balāsana — 60 sec
4. Sukhāsana with counted breath (4-in, 4-out) — 60 sec
5. Tāḍāsana — 30 sec

Use this before exams.

Homework

- Practise the stress-recovery sequence at least once before tomorrow’s class. Note when (morning / before bed / before a difficult task).
- Bring all project planning materials tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read a 1-page introduction to the polyvagal theory (Stephen Porges). What does it say about how social safety affects the vagus nerve?
- **Tier down:** Just remember: *slow exhale* = *calm body*. The other details can come later.

Teacher notes

- This is the most accessible “why does this work?” answer at Middle band. Connect it explicitly to PE class and biology if those teachers are interested.
- Some students may ask whether yoga is “scientifically proven.” Honest answer: many specific health claims for yoga are still under study; the physiological mechanism of slow-breath calming is well-established.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- No new RAG citations (this is a modern-physiology lesson).
- Modern reference: any introductory text on autonomic nervous system; for teacher, Stephen Porges’ polyvagal theory (advanced).

Day 8 — Project Session 1: Design Your Routine

Module: Yoga · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, every pair will have a written outline of a 5-minute yoga routine for their chosen audience, including specific āsanās, a breath element, and one source citation.

Materials

- All project planning materials.
- Printed rubric per pair.
- Stopwatch.

Lesson flow

Settle (2 min)

- Sukhāsana. 5 breaths.

Core (35 min) — Three sprints

Sprint 1 (10 min) — Plan. Pairs finalise: - Target audience (peers / parents / younger siblings / pre-exam classmates) - 5-minute sequence outline (which āsanās, in what order, with timing) - A breath element (counted breath or natural-breath segment) - The source they'll cite (verse, sūtra, or PDF reference) - Division of labour for the Day 10 demonstration

Sprint 2 (10 min) — Storyboard the sequence. On paper: - Draw each pose (stick figures fine) - Write the breath cue under each - Add time per pose - Total should be 5 minutes ± 30 seconds

Teacher checks every pair's storyboard.

Sprint 3 (15 min) — Try it. Each pair physically walks through their routine once at full speed. Teacher observes and gives one focused note.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One pair (volunteer) shows their full routine to the class — 5 min if there's time, else preview.
- Plan paragraph submitted at the door.
- Preview Day 9: refine + rehearse with a buddy pair.

Student-facing content

Project workshop — Session 1

By end of class, your pair should have:

1. A written outline of your 5-minute routine.
2. A storyboard drawing.
3. ONE physical run-through completed.

Outline template:

Audience: _____

Goal of routine (calming / energising / focusing / restorative): _____

Sequence: _____

0:00–0:30	_____	(breath: _____)
0:30–1:00	_____	(breath: _____)
1:00–2:00	_____	(breath: _____)
2:00–3:30	_____	(breath: _____)
3:30–4:30	_____	(breath: _____)
4:30–5:00	_____	(breath: _____)

Source citation: _____

Division of labour (Partner A leads sequences _____): _____

Division of labour (Partner B leads sequences _____): _____

Homework

- Whatever didn't get done in class: finish at home. Practise the routine 1 more time.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Add a 30-second “intention setting” at the start and “savasana” at the end. Make the 5 min feel complete.
- **Tier down:** Reuse Day 7’s stress-recovery sequence as your base; customise to your audience by adding 1–2 changes only.

Teacher notes

- Common pacing error: pairs plan 8 poses in 5 min, each held for 20 sec — but transitions take time too. Cue: “Plan for 4–5 poses with 30–60 sec each, plus a couple of breath segments.”
- Routines for younger siblings often need *engaging language* (animal poses, story narration). Encourage that.
- A pre-exam routine should be calming, not energising — flag this if a pair plans something high-energy.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- Pair-chosen source from `sources.md`, verified during Sprint 1.

Day 9 — Project Session 2: Refine and Rehearse

Module: Yoga · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, every pair will have rehearsed their 5-minute routine end-to-end and received feedback from a buddy pair.

Materials

- All in-progress materials.
- Mats laid out.
- Stopwatch.
- Feedback slip per pair.

Lesson flow

Settle (2 min)

- Sukhāsana. 5 breaths.

Core (30 min) — Two halves

Half 1 (15 min) — Refine. - Each pair runs their routine once on their own mats, timed. - Teacher rotates: 60 sec per pair, focused question: “Where does the energy of your routine drop?” - Common adjustments to flag: - Pace too fast — students rush through poses. - Breath cues missing. - Transitions clunky. - Source citation forgotten — must be spoken aloud.

Half 2 (15 min) — Buddy rehearsal. - Pair A demos routine to Pair B (mat-side). Pair B lies in the role of the target audience and tries to follow. - 5 min run + 2 min feedback. Swap. Total ~14 min for round.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence share: “What’s the one thing I’m changing before tomorrow?”
- Tomorrow: full presentations + summative quiz.

Student-facing content

Project workshop — Session 2: Refine + Rehearse

Checklist: - [] My routine fits in 5 min $\pm$ 30 sec. - [] I cite at least one source aloud (during intro or close). - [] My breath cues are clear. - [] My partner and I know who leads which pose. - [] I’ve heard feedback from one buddy pair and decided what to change.

Tomorrow you teach the class.

Homework

- Practise the full routine one more time. Bring everything tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Add a memorable 1-line “takeaway” the audience will remember after the 5 min.
- **Tier down:** Reduce to 3 poses + 1 breath segment if 4–5 poses isn’t sticking.

Teacher notes

- The buddy-pair rehearsal is the most useful feedback step. Encourage feedback as *kind and specific* — “the transition from down-dog to lunge felt slow” beats “good job.”
- Pairs who can’t complete a clean run-through by end of class need extra support — invite a 15-min lunch-time rehearsal if possible.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- Pair source verified.

Day 10 — Final Assessment + Routine Showcase

Module: Yoga · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 60 min (extended — book a double period if possible)

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will demonstrate mastery via a summative quiz and a 5-minute routine they lead the class through.

Materials

- Summative quiz (quizzes/summative.md).
- Mats for everyone (audience does the routine alongside the presenters).
- Stopwatch.
- Rubric per pair.

Lesson flow

Settle (2 min)

- Sukhāsana. 5 breaths.

Part 1: Summative Quiz (20 min)

- Distribute. Closed notebook.
- 25 marks: limb identification, āsana naming, breath co-ordination match, prāṇāyāma definition + one safety question, short answer on physiology, open response.

Part 2: Routine Showcase (35 min)

- Each pair leads a 5-minute routine.
- AUDIENCE PARTICIPATES — does the routine on their own mat as the pair leads.
- 7 minutes per pair (5 routine + 2 rubric mark + brief Q&A).
- ~5 pairs fit in 35 min. **Book next day for remaining pairs.**
- Teacher marks rubric in real-time.

Wrap-up (3 min)

- Closing namaste in tādāsana.
- Reflection slip submitted.

Student-facing content

Day 10: quiz + routine showcase

20-min quiz first (closed notebook).

5-minute routine showcase. The class will join you on their mats — you LEAD them through your routine.

Reflection (due at end of class): 1. What did you set out to make/learn, and what did you actually end up with? 2. What’s the most surprising thing you discovered while making this? 3. If you had three more days, what would you do differently?

Homework

- None. Module complete.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Students who finish quiz early write a 1-paragraph “what should change for Grade 11 students?” — input for Senior band.

- **Tier down:** Open-notebook quiz for students with documented learning needs.

Teacher notes

- Some pairs will get nervous leading the class — that’s OK. Quiet leading is leading.
- If the routine drifts off-time, gently signal but let them finish.
- Mark quizzes within 48 hours.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- All cited sources verified.

Writing Prompts

Writing Prompts — Module 8 Yoga (Middle)

Seven prompts. Useful as exit tickets, homework, or post-practice reflections.

Reflection prompts

- 1. (Day 1, end of class, 3 min)** Before this class, what did you think yoga was? In one sentence, how has that changed?
- 2. (Day 6, end of class, 5 min)** During the 5-minute natural-breath observation, what did you notice about your mind? Was it quiet, busy, drifting, focused?
- 3. (Day 7 or any later day, ~100 words)** Describe a moment outside class — maybe last night, maybe last week — when your body was clearly in “fight or flight” mode. What happened to your breath, your heart, your thoughts?

Explanatory prompts

- 4. (Day 3 or 4, homework, ~150 words)** Explain *Sūrya Namaskāra* to a friend who has never seen yoga. Name the 12 poses without using the words “yoga pose.”
- 5. (Day 7, homework, ~120 words)** In your own words, explain why slow exhalation makes the body feel calm. Use the words *vagus nerve* and *parasympathetic*.

Argumentative prompt

- 6. (Day 2 or 6, homework, 1 paragraph)** Some people say “yoga is just stretching.” Some say “yoga is religious and shouldn’t be in schools.” Some say “yoga is exercise that comes from India.” Pick the position you most disagree with and write 5–7 sentences explaining why you disagree, fairly.

Creative prompt

7. (Day 5 or 8, optional, 1 page) Write a short scene (50–150 words) in which two students argue about whether to skip yoga class. One wants to. One doesn't. End with one of them noticing something they hadn't expected.

Prompt-to-band notes

- **Primary** band: prompts 1, 2, 4, 7 work as drawings or oral responses.
- **Senior** band: prompt 6 deserves a 1–2 page essay with citations; prompt 3 can connect to specific scientific research.

Homework

Homework — Module 8 Yoga (Middle)

Day 1 → Day 2

Task: Practice tādāsana for 60 seconds tomorrow morning before brushing your teeth. Notice how your body feels.

Time: 2 min + observation.

Day 2 → Day 3

Task: Memorise the 8 limbs in order. Practise tādāsana + vṛkṣāsana for 5 min before breakfast.

Time: 10 min.

Day 3 → Day 4

Task: Choose 3 of the 5 foundational āsanās. Practise them for 5 min before bed. Note in workbook: how you felt before vs. after.

Time: 10 min.

Day 4 → Day 5

Task: Practise 1 round of Sūrya Namaskāra at home, slowly. Note which transitions felt awkward.

Time: 5 min.

Day 5 → Day 6

Task: Practise 1 round of SN with breath co-ordination. Submit project plan paragraph.

Time: 15 min.

Day 6 → Day 7

Task: Practise the counted breath (4 in, 4 out) for 3 minutes before bed. Note: “Felt _____ before, _____ after.”

Time: 5 min.

Day 7 → Day 8

Task: Practise the stress-recovery sequence at least once. Bring all project materials tomorrow.

Time: 5 min + material gathering.

Day 8 → Day 9

Task: Practise your full 5-min routine at home. Finish anything that wasn’t done in class.

Time: 15 min.

Day 9 → Day 10

Task: Practise the routine one more time. Bring everything tomorrow.

Time: 10 min.